The Case for Open Source *Alignment*

Why alignment to open source strengthens Mojaloop implementations — for adopters, implementers, and the ecosystem as a whole



Adopter Experience

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Open Source Alignment Is Like a Geopolitical Alliance

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Nations trade independence for alliance benefits — Mojaloop adopters trade customization for shared standards and faster innovation.

Key Concepts



Mitigate Downside Risk

Maintenance and Security

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Maximize Upside Opportunity

Functionality and Experience

Alignment is most often blocked by non-technical reasons, not technical ones.

For Adopters: Maintenance and Support



- No lock-in to a single implementer
- Easier to upgrade to newer versions, and to bug and security fixes
- In the age of AI, this is even more important
- More eyes looking at the code

For Adopters: Functionality and Experience

- Instant payments is a rapidly changing space
- Faster access to new functionality as the ecosystem builds it
- Better access to key adjacencies and global partnerships
- The chance to collaborate with other adopters to design new functionality

For Implementers

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- Earns the trust of adopters who want open source
- More visibility across the ecosystem
- Lower costs for customers adopting new functionality
- Lower costs for implementation



Challenges to Alignment

- Connections to legacy systems
- Legacy standards
- Alignment often required across banks and other financial institutions
- Desire to reduce immediate cost to participants
- Not enough time or money budgeted during implementation



Overcoming the Obstacles

Alignment to open source doesn't happen by accident — it takes deliberate planning from the start.

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Four Ways Forward

Budget time and money during implementation to compare against open-source options

Make alignment a contractual requirement from the RFP stage

Plan for wide stakeholder engagement to build understanding of the benefits

Implement CI/CD best practices

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A Note for International Funders and PMOs

Skipping this step doesn't save money — it costs more. Without it, each implementation in other markets becomes longer and more expensive.

Thank You

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